

THE FRUIT BAT

Small Space Gardening 101

Take-Home Growing Guide

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You do not need a backyard to grow something useful. A balcony, patio, windowsill, porch, or a few containers can be enough to get started.

Start With the Space You Have

- 1. Learn your light.** Watch your space for a day. Is it getting direct sun, bright indirect light, or mostly shade? Match the plant to the light you actually have.
- 2. Pick the right container.** Containers help you control space, soil and water. Make sure excess water has somewhere to drain.
- 3. Use potting mix.** For containers, use a mix intended for pots rather than packing them with dense garden soil.
- 4. Check before watering.** Do not water only because it is 'watering day.' Feel the soil and observe the plant.
- 5. Pay attention.** Gardening is an experiment. A struggling plant is giving you information.

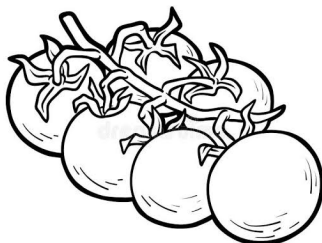
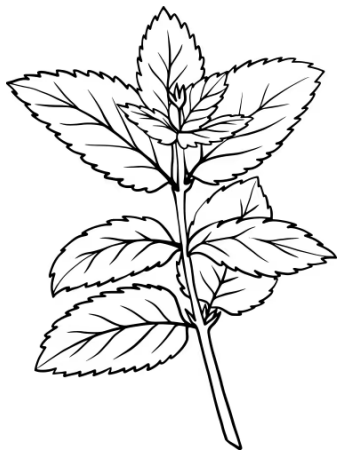
Easy Plants to Learn With

Mint: vigorous, useful, easy to propagate, and especially well suited to containers because it can spread aggressively when planted in the ground.

Tomatoes: rewarding and fast-growing in warm weather, but they need plenty of light, consistent care, and enough room for their variety.

Herbs: many herbs work beautifully in compact spaces and give you something you can actually use in the kitchen.

Experiment: peppers, dragon fruit, figs, cactus/nopal and other edibles can also be container-grown when their needs match your conditions.



When Something Goes Wrong

Seedlings get tall, thin or weak	They may need stronger light. Germination does not mean the plant has enough light to keep growing well.
Soil stays wet for a long time	Reduce watering frequency and check drainage. Constantly soggy roots can become stressed.
Tiny flies hover around the soil	Fungus gnats like persistently moist growing media. Let appropriate plants dry somewhat between waterings and use sticky traps to reduce adults.
Tomato fruit develops a dark end	Blossom-end rot is associated with poor calcium delivery to developing fruit, often related to inconsistent soil moisture. Aim for steady watering rather than dramatic wet/dry swings.
Tomato is getting huge	On indeterminate tomatoes, side shoots called suckers grow where a leaf branch meets the main stem - the plant's little 'armpit.' Selective pruning can help manage size and airflow in tight spaces.



The Forever Mint Trick

Your mint plant can become more mint - and eventually a plant you can share with somebody else.

SNIP	Choose a healthy stem and cut just below a node.
STRIP	Remove the leaves from the lowest part of the cutting.
ROOT	Place the stem into moist potting mix, or root it in water first.
WAIT	Keep the new cutting in bright, indirect light while roots establish.
GROW	Once established, care for it as mint and harvest by pinching or snipping stems.
SHARE	When yours gets big enough, make another cutting and pass it along.

Try it: Use your mint in tea, cold drinks, salads, fruit, or try it with watermelon. Then propagate your plant and see how your new cutting compares with the original.

Your Small-Space Garden Notes

What do I want to grow? _____

How much light does my space get? _____

What is one problem I want to solve? _____

What did I learn from my plant this week? _____

Keep Growing With Us

This workshop is the beginning, not the finish line. Use The Fruit Bat's Small Space Gardening 101 page for workshop notes, future growing tips, troubleshooting, events, and the community grow-along.



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QR code for sharing with others

Grow what you can. Learn from what happens. Share what you learn.

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